KHULNA DIVISION

EXPLORING KHULNA

Location of Khulna Division

Area: 22,284.22 sq km
Location: Between **21°60' and 24°13' north latitudes** and **88°34' and 89°58' east longitudes**

Boundaries:

- **North: Rajshahi**, **Natore** and **Pabna** districts
- **South: Bay of Bengal**
- **East: Rajbari**, **Faridpur**, **Gopalganj**, **Pirojpur** and **Barguna** districts
- **West: West Bengal** state of **India**

The Sundarbans, the world's largest mangrove forest, is located in this division, covering **southern parts of Satkhira, Khulna, and Bagerhat** districts.

Map of Khulna Division

Demographics of Khulna Division

Total population: 15,687,759

- Male: 7,842,533
- Female: 7,845,226

Religious composition:

- Muslim: 13,617,984
- Hindu: 2,016,564
- Christian: 43,159
- Buddhist: 417
- Others: 9,635

Administrative Structure of Khulna Division

Khulna Division is the second largest of the eight divisions of Bangladesh. Its headquarters and largest city is Khulna city in Khulna District.

Division										
Area (sq km)	City corporation	District	Upazila	Pauras abha	Union	Ward	Population		Density (per sq km)	Literacy rate (%)
							Urban	Rural		
22284.22	1	10	59	36	327	571	2822121	12865638	704	53.2

Administrative Structure of Khulna Division

Name of District	Area (sq km)	Upazila	Density (per sq km)	Literacy rate (%)
Khulna	4394.45	9	528	60.1
Jhenaidah	1964.77	6	902	48.4
Magura	1039.10	4	884	50.6
Kushtia	1608.80	6	1210	46.3
Jessore	2606.94	8	1060	56.5
Bagerhat	3959.11	9	373	59.0
Chuadanga	1174.10	4	962	45.9
Meherpur	751.62	3	872	46.3
Narail	967.99	3	746	61.3
Satkhira	3817.29	7	520	52.1

Khulna City Corporation

Khulna City Corporation (KCC) is the principal **local government authority** responsible for providing civic services in the city of **Khulna**, one of the major divisional urban centers in Bangladesh.

Electoral Governance
The **administration of KCC** is determined by a **popular vote held every five years**. The corporation is headed by an **elected mayor**, supported by **41 councillors**, who collectively manage the city's public services, infrastructure, and municipal policies.

Legal and Institutional Framework
KCC functions under the provisions of the **City Corporation Act, 2009**, which outlines its legal jurisdiction, responsibilities, and administrative authority. It operates under the supervision of the **Ministry of Local Government, Rural Development and Co-operatives (LGRD)**.

Khulna City Corporation

Historical Background

- The origins of KCC date back to the establishment of **Khulna Municipality in 1884**, making it one of the oldest municipal institutions in the country.
- It was upgraded to a **municipal corporation in 1984**, reflecting the city's growing administrative and demographic importance.
- Later, it was formally declared a **city corporation**, with expanded responsibilities and autonomy.

Autonomy and Legal Oversight

As a **self-governing entity**, Khulna City Corporation operates independently in managing local affairs, city planning, and community services. To address legal matters within its jurisdiction, it is supported by the **Chief Metropolitan Magistrate (CMM) Court**.

Educational Institutes in Khulna Division

Khulna Division, particularly Khulna city, is home to several well-known educational institutions. Prominent among these are universities, colleges, and schools.

UNIVERSITIES

Khulna University (KU): A public research university established in 1991, known for its academic programs and research activities.

Khulna University of Engineering and Technology (KUET): A public engineering university, renowned for its technical education and research.

Khulna Agricultural University (KU): A public university specializing in agricultural sciences and related fields.

Jashore University of Science and Technology (JUST): A public university located in Jashore, within the Khulna Division.

Educational Institutes in Khulna Division

COLLEGES

Khulna Collegiate Girls' School & KCC Women's College: A well-established institution for girls, offering various academic programs.

Khulna Govt. Girls College: A government-run college for girls, known for its academic rigor and traditions.

Govt. Sundarban Adarsha College: A government-run college offering a range of academic programs.

Educational Institutes in Khulna Division

SCHOOLS

Lions School & College: A reputed school known for its academic excellence.

Khulna Model School and College: A well-regarded school offering quality education.

Bangladesh Noubahini School and College Khulna: A school affiliated with the Bangladesh Navy, known for its discipline and academic focus.

History of Khulna Division

- **Ancient Period**: Part of ancient kingdoms such as **Vanga**, **Gangaridai**, and **Samatata**.
- **Medieval Era**: Ruled by the **Sena dynasty** in the 12th century. In the 14th century, **Shamsuddin Firoz Shah** became the first Muslim ruler in the region. **Khan Jahan Ali**, a 15th-century Muslim saint, established settlements and renamed the area **Jahanabad**.
- **Mughal Period**: In the 16th century, **Vikramaditya** established a sovereign kingdom in southern Bengal, succeeded by his son **Pratapaditya**, who controlled the region until defeated by Mughal forces in 1611.
- **British Colonial Era**: In 1793, the British East India Company took control, integrating Khulna into **Jessore District** in 1842. Khulna became a district headquarters in 1882 and was declared a **municipality in 1884**.
- **Post-Partition**: Initially declared as part of India in 1947, Khulna was later included in **East Bengal (Pakistan)** following boundary commission decisions.
- **Administrative Formation**: In **1960**, Khulna Division was established, comprising districts from Rajshahi and Dacca Divisions.
- **Liberation War**: During the **1971 Bangladesh Liberation War**, Khulna was a strategic location defended by the Pakistan Army's 314th ad hoc Brigade. Local resistance was led by **Mukti Bahini** fighters.

Tourist and Archaeological Sites in Khulna

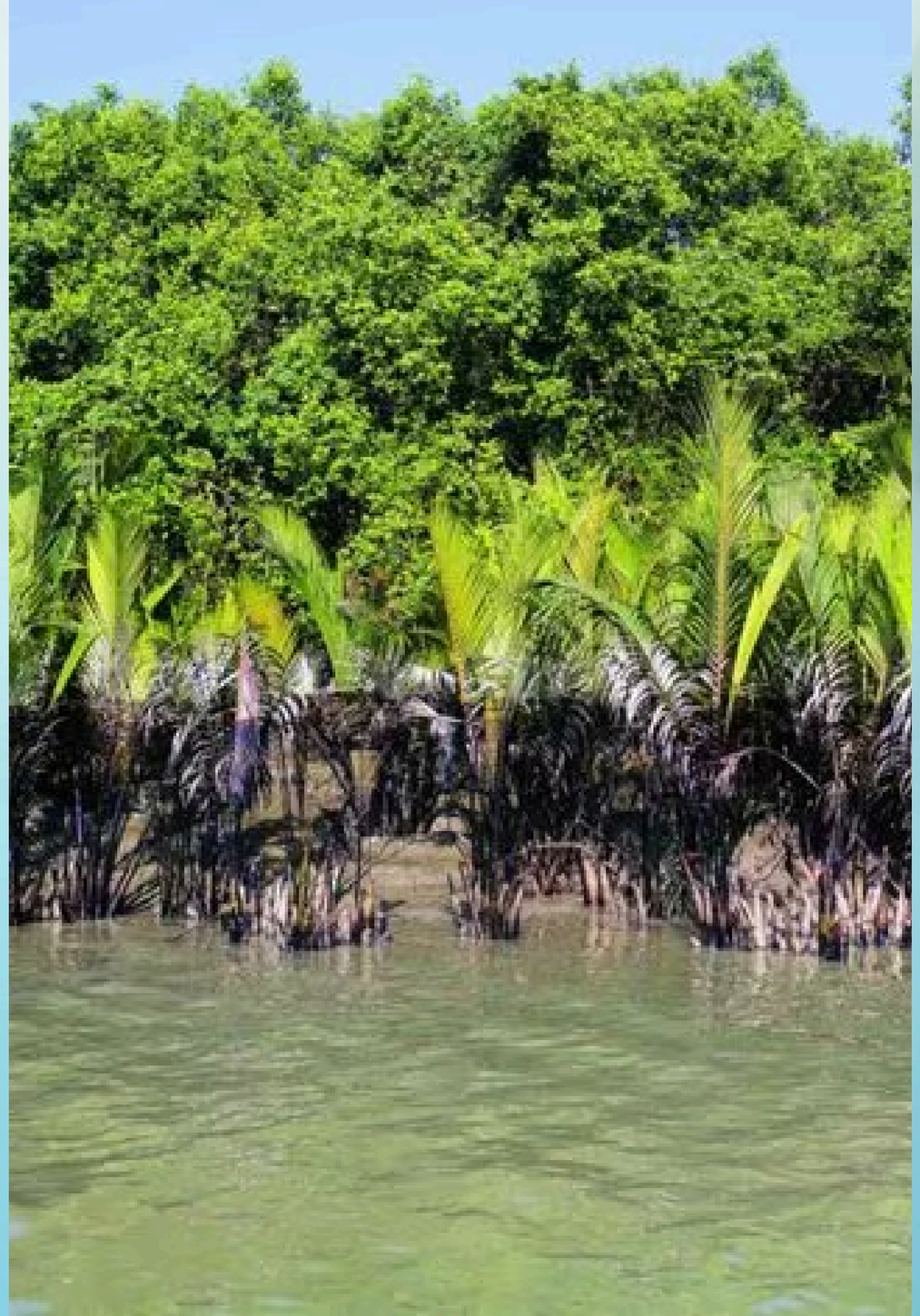
Sundarban

The Sundarbans undoubtedly the crown jewel, the Sundarbans, a UNESCO World Heritage Site, is the largest contiguous mangrove forest on Earth. It covers an area of approximately 10,000 square kilometers, located in the southwestern part of Bangladesh. 60% of the property lies in Bangladesh and the rest in India. The most lavish tree species are sundari (Heritiera fomes) and gewa (Excoecaria agallocha).

The Sundarbans is home to several endangered species, including the Royal Bengal Tiger, Chital, Crocodile etc. which is estimated to have a population of around 200-300 in the Bangladeshi part of the forest.

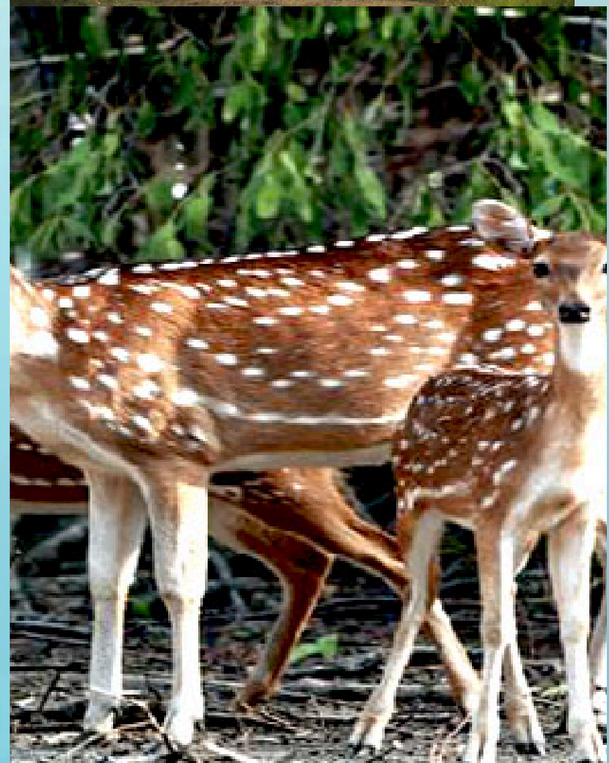
- The Sundarbans provides sustainable livelihoods for millions of people in the vicinity of the site and acts as a shelter belt to protect the people from storms, cyclones, tidal surges, sea water seepage and intrusion. The area provides livelihood in certain seasons for large numbers of people living in small villages surrounding the property, working variously as wood-cutters, fisherman, honey gatherers, leaves and grass gatherers.

- Tourism numbers remain relatively low due to the difficult access, arranging transport and a lack of facilities including suitable accommodation. Mass tourism and its impacts are unlikely to affect the values of the property.



Hiron Point

Hiron Point is a beautiful spot, great for spotting tigers and other rare wildlife animals.
Also known as Nilkamal is a beautiful tourist destination in the Sundarbans South Wildlife Reservation. It is located on the western bank of the Kunga River with a long jetty and is a safe haven for tigers, deer, monkeys, birds, and reptiles. It is also an excellent spot for birding where one can see many kingfishers and egrets as well as various types of butterflies. At Keorasuti, 3 km from Hiron Point, there is an observation tower. It also offers dense mangrove forests, grassland, and stunning beaches.



Dublar Char

Dublar Char (Dubla Island) is an important tourist spot near Hiron Point on the coast of the Bay of Bengal. Fishermen live here for 6 months of the year (October to March) as they prepare dry fish. The popular Hindu festival Rash Mela takes place here in November during the full moon, to which thousands of religious devotees' flock and has become a carnival-type tourist attraction in the Sundarbans. There is also an old lighthouse located on the island. It is a great experience for both local and international tourists to see the life of these fishermen and their fishing business on this tiny island. Dublar char is also famous for Seagulls.

Jamtola Beach

- Jamtola Beach, located within the breathtaking Sundarbans mangrove forest, serves as a serene getaway for tourists looking to escape the hustle and bustle of city life. The beach is renowned for its unspoiled beauty, characterized by golden sands that stretch along the coastline, leading into the tranquil waters of the Bay of Bengal.
- The surrounding landscape is dotted with lush greenery and the unique flora of the mangrove ecosystem, offering a stunning backdrop for photography enthusiasts and nature lovers alike.
- Beyond its natural allure, Jamtola Beach is a cultural hub where tourists can immerse themselves in the local way of life. Interactive experiences such as fishing trips with local fishermen or guided tours of the mangrove forests provide insight into the region's rich biodiversity and cultural heritage. The beach is also a great spot for birdwatching, as it attracts numerous migratory birds during the winter months. The nearby villages often host local markets where visitors can sample traditional Bengali cuisine, shop for handicrafts, and interact with friendly locals, ensuring a memorable visit.

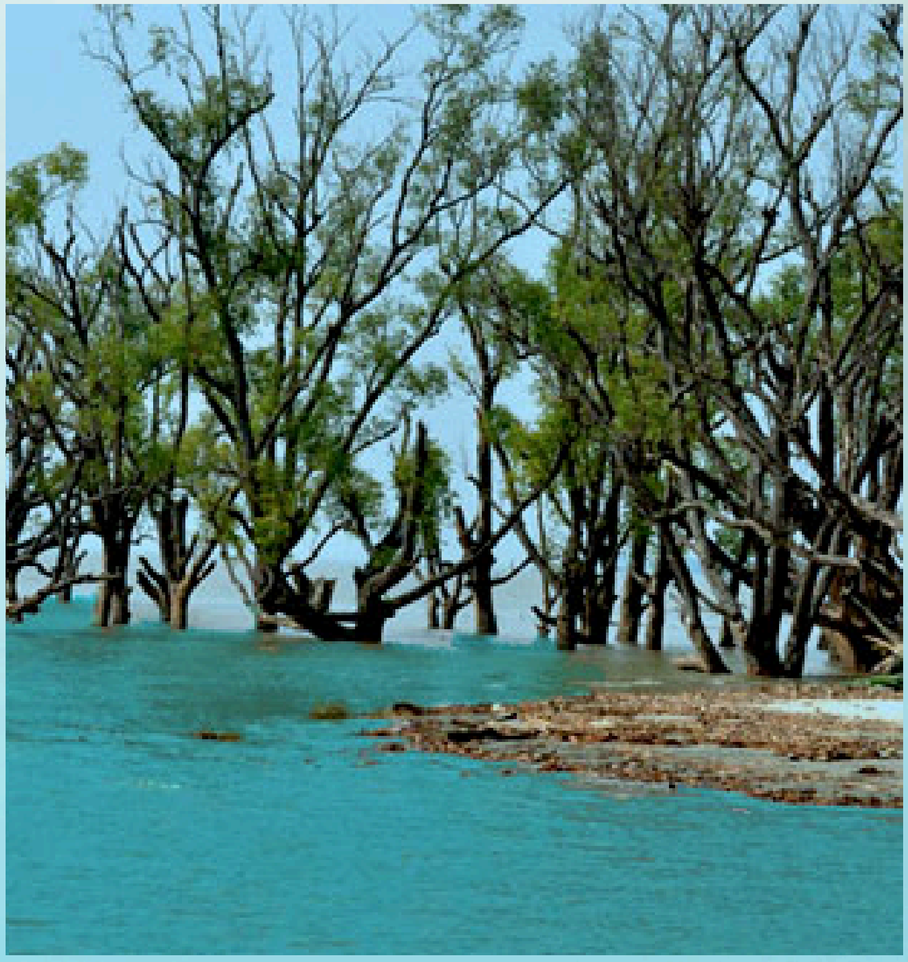
Kochikhali

- Kochikhali, which is often referred to as Tiger Point, is very popular amongst visitors wanting to venture deep into the forest. With a location in the lap of the Bay of Bengal within the Sundarbans East Wildlife Sanctuary, you can truly take in the scenic beauty of the forest, embarking on jungle treks or relaxed strolls through the forest. Kochikhali beach is also an attractive destination with jetty access, a dense forest, and a foot trail for visitors.

Kotka

- Katka is one of Heritage sites in Sunderban. Katka a base for safaris, and well spot to see tigers and for bird-watching. Katka is well known for many rare and majestic wild animals. At Katka, one can see many precious wild animals right from tigers to deer and also varieties of birds and many kinds of monkeys. Here one can hear the natures' music mixed with the wild fowls in the mornings and evenings.

- For those interested in wildlife trekking, the vast expanse of grassy meadows running from Katka to Kachikhali (Tiger Point) is an ideal route.



Karamjal

Karmajal is one of the wonderful visiting place in sundarban. To appreciate and to view the most precious species of Bangladesh’s wildlife, thousands of visitors make their way to Karamjol, a ranger station deep in the forest that also serves as a deer-breeding center. Bangladesh has some exquisite wildlife species that are unique to the country, and Karamjol is one of the gateways to the majestic wildlife sanctuary, Sundarban.

The Port of Mongla

The Port of Mongla is a link seaport, located at Mongla Upazila, Khulna Division, Bangladesh. It is a sea port of Khulna city, which is located to the north shore of the Bay of Bengal. It is the second largest and second busiest seaport of Bangladesh after the Port of Chittagong. The Mongla port lies close to the shore of the Bay of Bengal and Pashur river and divisional city Khulna.It is also connected by rail with Khulna. Also an airport is being under construction near the post area named Khan Jahan Ali Airport Mongla was renowned historically among the major important ports of the Bengal delta. Due to the increasing congestion in Bangladesh's largest port in Chittagong, many international shipping companies have turned to Mongla as an alternative. Also the continuous demand from all over the country and neighbouring countries has made it busier and economically attractive.

Khulna D

Shat Gumbud Mosque

Bagerhat - Mosque City of Bagerhat-City of Mosques

Bagerhat is a historic town located in the Khulna division of Bangladesh. It was founded in the 15th century by a Turkish general named Khan Jahan Ali, who was appointed as the governor of the region by the Sultan of Bengal. During his tenure,Khan Jahan Ali established several mosques and shrines in the town, including the famous Shat Gambuj Mosque. In reality the mosques has 81 domes that are supported by sixty columns or stone pillars. There are 77 low domes arranged in seven rows of eleven, with an additional dome on each corner, bringing the total to 81 domes.

The Sixty Dome Mosque stands as a testimony to Bagerhat's historical significance. Constructed with domes and adorned with intricate terracotta details, it reflects a unique blend of Islamic and local architecture. As a UNESCO World Heritage Site, Bagerhat offers a glimpse into Bangladesh's glorious past.

Bagerhat Museum

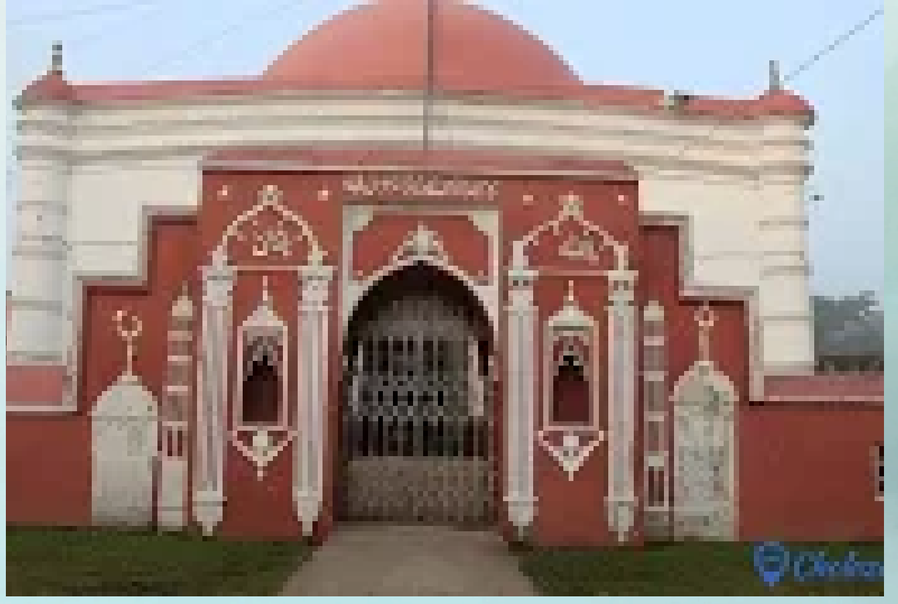
Bagerhat Museum is located on the southeastern corner of Shat Gambuj Masjid (60 dome mosque) in Bagerhat. It was built in 1995 to preserve the memory of Khan Jahan Ali and the Muslim culture of the area.

The museum has been designed to show the artifacts collected from the Bagerhat region. During the reign of the Bengal ruler Nasiruddin Mahmud Shah (1442-1459), Khan Jahan Ali developed this region. He constructed many roads, marketplaces, mosques, and tanks for the welfare of the people. It is heard that this great man started to dig 360 lakes in 360 mosques in the entire area starting from Jessore's Baro Bazar.

To preserve the memory of Khan Jahan Ali, the Museum was built with the help of UNESCO’s fund in 1995.

Khan Jahan Ali ‘s Tomb

Khan Jahan Ali's Tomb, located in Bagerhat District, is a significant historical and religious site dedicated to the revered Sufi saint Khan Jahan Ali. The tomb is an important pilgrimage site and a place of cultural and historical interest.



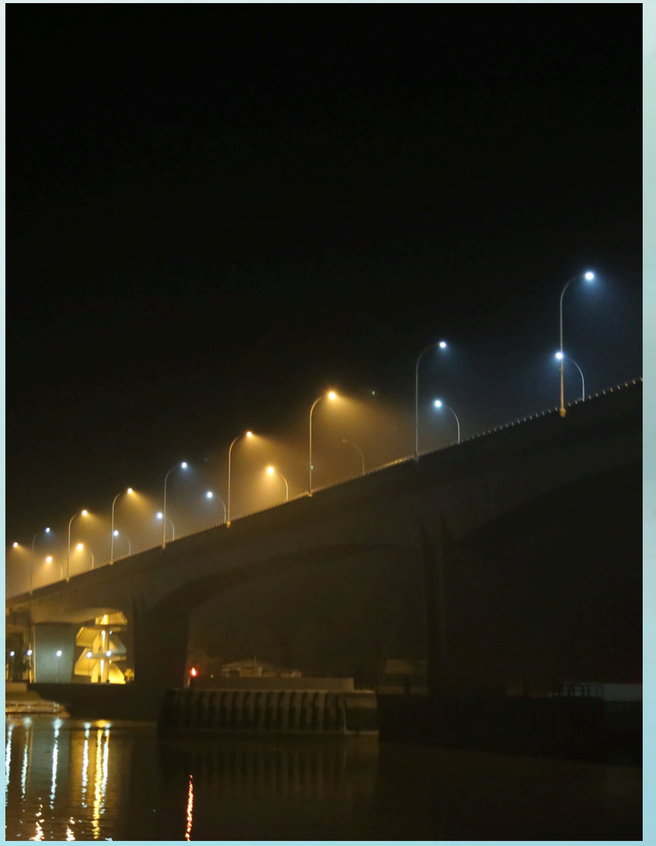
Enclosed within a brick boundary, the mausoleum is part of a complex containing an identical mosque and a ruined brick structure with a sloping roof that served, perhaps, as a gateway or the kitchen. Khan Jahan lived a religious life here from his retirement to his death on 25th October 1459. The tomb is part of a larger complex along with the Khan Jahan Ali’s dighi (lake) and a single dome mosque. The mausoleum is situated on the northern part of the complex, aligned with the mosque.

Thakur Dighi

Khan Jahan Dighi is located on the southern side of Hazrat Khan Jahan Ali (Rh)’s Shrine, occupying about 200 bighas of land. Hazrat Khan Jahan Ali (Rh) released a few crocodiles in this dighi. Two large-sized crocodiles named 'Kala Pahar' and 'Dhala Pahar' were very famous in Khan Jahan dighi. But they died later. Some sweet water crocodiles were also released in the dighi. People coming to visit the shrine feed the crocodiles with ducks, hens, sheep, and goats. Dighi's main ramp is spacious and beautiful. There are separate ramps for the women. This dighi is also called the Thakur Dighi.

KhanJhan Ali Bridge

KhanJahan Ali Bridge is a bridge built near Khulna city on the Rupsa River. It is also known as the Rupsa Bridge. The distance of the bridge from Khulna city is 4.80 km. This bridge can be called the gateway of Khulna City because the bridge connects the southern districts, especially the Mongla seaport with Khulna City. Besides connecting the Khulna district and Bagerhat district, this bridge is playing an important role in the country's economy.

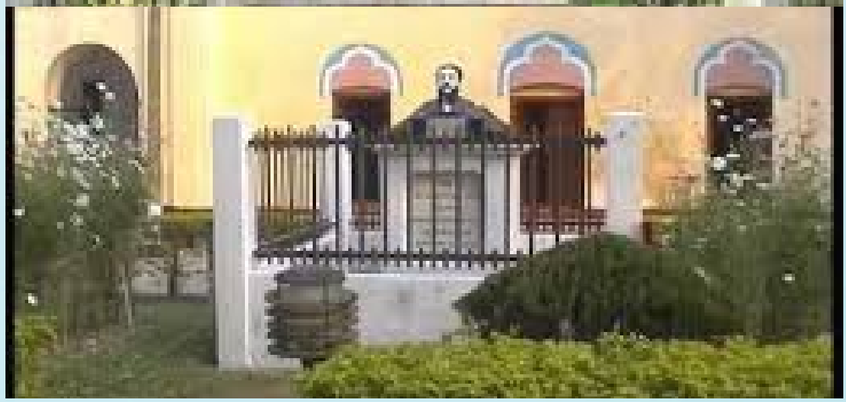


Shilaidaha Kuthibari

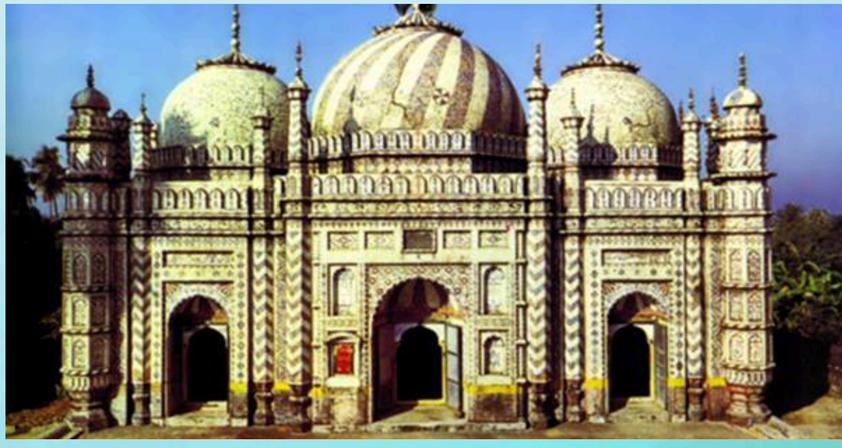
Shilaidaha Rabindra Kuthibari, located in Kushtia, Bangladesh, is a historic mansion that holds immense cultural and literary significance. This beautiful estate was once the residence of the revered Bengali poet and Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore. Kuthibari served as a source of inspiration for many of Tagore's literary works and is now a museum dedicated to his life and legacy. The serene environment, coupled with the rich historical context, makes Shilaidaha Rabindra Kuthibari a must-visit destination for literature enthusiasts and cultural explorers.

Tagore stayed intermittently between 1891 and 1901 at Shilaidaha Kuthibari. Sitting at Kuthibari or on a boat on Padma, Tagore wrote a number of masterpieces such as “Sonar Tori”, “Chitra”, “Chaitali”, “Katha O Kahini”, “Kshanika”, most of the poems from “Naibedya” and “Kheya”, and songs from “Gitanjali” and “Gitimalya”. It was here, in 1912, that the poet started translating his “Gitanjali” into English, which earned him the Nobel Prize in 1913.

The Michael Madhusudan Dutt Memorial, located in Sagardari, Jessore, is dedicated to the renowned Bengali poet and dramatist Michael Madhusudan Dutt. This memorial celebrates the life and works of one of Bengal's literary giants and serves as a cultural and educational landmark.

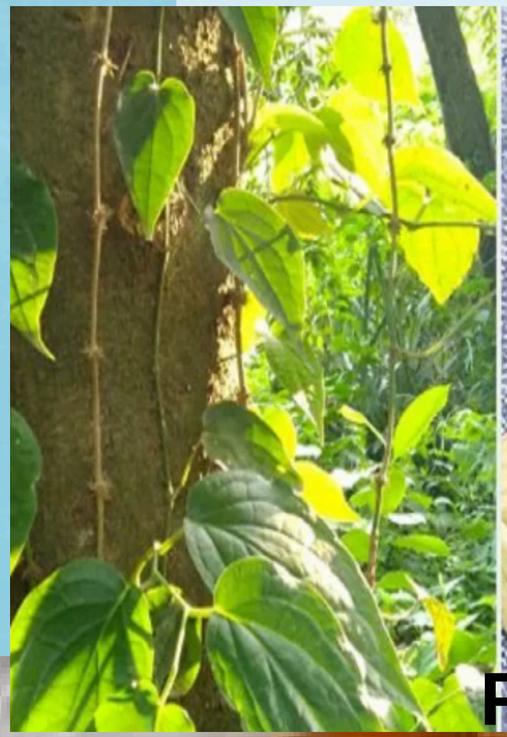


Embark on a historical journey at the Shahi Mosque, a captivating testament to Mughal-era architecture in Jessore, Bangladesh. While the exact construction date remains unclear, some believe it was built during the reign of Emperor Aurangzeb in the 17th century. The mosque's grandeur lies in its three majestic domes and four minarets, showcasing the influence of Mughal design principles.



Godkhali Flower Garden

- The Godkhali Flower Garden, aptly nicknamed the "Flower Capital of Bangladesh." Located in Jhikargacha Upazila, Jessore, this vast expanse of cultivated fields bursts with over 15 varieties of flowers, including roses, gerberas, marigolds, tuberoses, and gladiolus. The fragrant air and mesmerizing floral landscapes make Godkhali a must-visit for nature lovers, photographers, and anyone seeking a delightful escape.



Food

Khulna's Chuijhal: The Spicy Secret of Southern Bangladesh

Khulna's Food

Chui jhal is one of the most popular dishes in Khulna. It is a fiery curry made with beef or goat meat and a type of wild pepper called chui. Chui jhal is said to have originated in the Satkhira district of Khulna but it is popular all over Bangladesh. Even though Chui is traditionally cooked with red meat, people in Khulna also cook chicken and prawns with it. Chui, also known as Piper Chaba or Piper chili, is a medicinal plant native to South and Southeast Asia, a flowering vine in the Piperaceae family. In Bangladesh, the stems of the plant are used as a spice in meat and fish dishes.

Chui Jhal

Prawn Brain Bhuna

Chingri brain bhuna is a popular Bengali dish from Khulna, Bangladesh. It is made with shrimp brains, which are cooked in a spicy tomato-onion gravy.

Another ingredient that is native to the Khulna region. **Keora Dal** is a delicious and fragrant lentil dish. It is made with lentils, Keora fruit, and spices. Keora has a sweet and floral aroma that adds a unique flavour to the dish.

Khulna's Food

Khulna, a city in southwestern Bangladesh, is known for its rich cultural heritage and delicious cuisine. Here are three popular dishes from Khulna's food culture:

Hilsa is the national fish of Bangladesh and a staple in Jessore. Shorshe Ilish (hilsa fish in mustard sauce) is also a classic Bengali preparation — hilsa cooked in a rich mustard sauce is a lovely balance of spice and tang.

Bhuna Khichuri is a spicy and flavorful rice and lentil dish that is popular in Khulna. It is made by cooking rice and lentils together with a blend of spices, including cumin, coriander, turmeric, and chili powder. The dish is usually served with a side of vegetables and fried fish.

Kachagolla (similar to Roshogolla but with a thicker texture) is a sweet delicacy of chhena (cottage cheese) and sugar syrup. It is a popular dish during festivals and special occasions.

Jessore is also renowned in Bangladesh for its mangoes, especially the Langra and the Gopalbhog. These mangoes are eaten raw in the summer season or used in making Aam Doi (mango yogurt) and other desserts.

Khulna

Khan Jahan popularly known as khan jahan ali, a celebrated sufi saint and a ruler over a territory comprising part of greater districts of Jessore and Khulna. Khan Jahan was entitled Ulugh Khan and Khan-i-Azam and flourished at Khalifatabad (Bagerhat) in the first half of the fifteenth century when the later Iliyas Shahi Sultan nasiruddin mahmud shah (1435-1459) was ruling at Gaur.

Khan Jahan died on 25 October 1459 (27 Zilhajj 863 AH) and was buried in the tomb built by himself. People have great reverence for him, and numerous people visit his tomb.

Mausoleum of Khan Jahan

Michael Madhusudan Dutt (born Sri Madhusudan Dutta; was a Bengali poet and playwright. He is considered one of the pioneers of Bengali literature.

Madhusudan was born in Sagardari, a village in Keshabpur Upazila, Jessore District of Bengal (present-day Bangladesh), to a Hindu family.

He was a pioneer of Bengali drama. His famous work Meghnad Badh Kavya, is a tragic Novel, centring round the heroic figure of Indrajit, Ravan's son. It has nine cantos and is exceptional in Bengali literature both in terms of style and content. He also wrote poems about the sorrows and pains of love as spoken by women. Dutt is widely said to be one of the greatest poets in Bengali literature. He is the father of the Bengali sonnet.

Sultan, SM (1923-1994) a renowned painter. His full name was Sheikh Mohammad Sultan but he is more widely known as SM Sultan. He was born on 10 August 1923 at Masimdia, a village in Narail district. His father worked as a mason, and Sultan joined him after five years of schooling at the Victoria Collegiate School in Narail. Sultan also began to draw the buildings his father used to work on and thus developed a liking for art.

His fame rests on his striking depictions of exaggeratedly muscular Bengali peasants engaged in the activities of their everyday lives.

Chardakhal, Oil painting on board, 1976 by SM Sultan

He is a Bangladeshi actor, screenwriter and television director. His works generally consist of television films and telenovelas. His notable works include the television films Basto Doctor (2004), Goruchor (2007), Dholer Baddo (2008) and Warren (2009), along with the telenovelas Ronger Manush (2004), Vober Hat (2007), Ghor Kutum (2008), Alta Sundori (2009) and Sakin Sarisuri (2009).

CONCLUSION

Khulna is the southwestern part of Bangladesh It is known for its rich history, diverse culture, and beautiful natural attractions, such as the Sundarbans National Park. Additionally, Khulna's local food and traditional clothing offer a glimpse into the unique and vibrant culture of the region.

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